

SMARIKA SHRESTHA

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Shades of Green Landscape Architecture | Sausalito, CA

Landscape Architecture Intern

February 2025 – May 2025

- Supported design development for residential landscape projects by collaborating with designers to create detailed planting plans, spatial layouts, and material palettes, enabling timely project completion and successful client approvals.
- Produced and refined planting plans and construction documentation using AutoCAD and Rhino, incorporating multidisciplinary feedback to enhance design accuracy and reduce revision cycles.
- Developed detailed project-specific plan, detail, sectional drawings and construction documents, ensuring clear communication of design intent and facilitating smooth construction phases across multiple projects.
- Streamlined plant selection workflows by organizing and maintaining the firm's plant library, increasing efficiency in species selection and design visualization for the project team.
- Conducted site and precedent research, analyzing microclimates, species suitability, and materials to inform sustainable and context-sensitive landscape design concepts.
- Conducted site visits to assess construction progress and ensure alignment with design intent, identifying coordination needs that enhanced field implementation and informed ongoing design improvements.
- Developed a comprehensive understanding of the landscape architecture project lifecycle by participating in all studio phases-from conceptual design to construction documentation-while strengthening collaboration and communication skills in a professional office environment.

GrizzlyCorps, Center for Law Energy & the Environment (CLEE) | Berkeley, CA

Student Administrative Assistant

June 2024 – Present

- Developed and executed digital content strategies across social media platforms, increasing engagement by 30% through compelling visual storytelling and strategic outreach. Streamlined data management processes, improving efficiency by 20% and enhancing accuracy in tracking large-scale projects, reflecting strong project coordination and organizational skills.
- Designed 30+ promotional materials using Canva and collaborated with diverse stakeholders to support outreach efforts and program visibility, demonstrating creativity and fostering community engagement and inclusive design principles.

Social Sciences Research Pathways (SSRP) | Berkeley, CA

Undergraduate Research Intern

September 2023 – May 2024

- Spearheaded research project on the political economy of warehouse development in California, resulting in a 20% increase in data analysis efficiency and a 15% improvement in result interpretation accuracy.
- Sourced data from 20+ California cities, employing ArcGIS to create insightful maps that visualized findings and enhanced presentations. Conducted comprehensive literature reviews, synthesizing insights from over 50 research articles to support project objectives.

EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley | Berkeley, CA

Bachelor of Arts: Landscape Architecture

Aug 2021 – May 2025

- **Relevant Coursework:** Fundamentals of Landscape Design: Developed skills in programmatic, artistic, and technical aspects of landscape design, focusing on sculptural landforms, topographic plans, sections, and contour models.
- Drawing Workshop II: Acquired proficiency in essential digital tools through lectures, lab exercises, and projects, emphasizing technical skills and creative workflows between software applications such as AutoCAD, SketchUp, Rhino, InDesign and Adobe Creative Suite.
- Design in Detail: Explored the properties and applications of landscape materials such as concrete, stone, wood, and metals. Focused on technical drawings, ADA compliance, and material selection for outdoor environments, with an emphasis on developing design development sets for multi-scale projects.
- Landscape Plant Identification and Use: Studied plant identification, selection, and utilization in landscape design. Explored plant species, characteristics, and ecological functions to inform design decisions and enhance project aesthetics and ecology.

SKILLS

Technical: AutoCAD, Rhino, Adobe Creative Suite (Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign), ArcGIS, SketchUp, Canva, Microsoft Office, Google Suite, data management, spatial planning, technical drawing, site analysis, GIS mapping, green infrastructure, regenerative landscapes, native plant design, CAD design, digital modeling, 3D rendering, architectural drafting

Soft: Concept development, environmental storytelling, community engagement, outreach strategies, event planning, communication, collaboration, project management, creative problem-solving, time management, research, adaptability, attention to detail, leadership, teamwork, client relations, visual storytelling, cross-functional collaboration, critical thinking